again—in fact, four more times—but every time, he hung up on me. He was insisting on speaking to me face to face, which the Secret Service agents wouldn't permit.

While the agents searched the golf course and the woods around it to discover whether the man had any accomplices, they urged me to return immediately to Washington. I vetoed the idea. I was safe and didn't think we should make any sudden moves that would suggest an air of crisis; this might encourage the press to start digging and learn about the Grenada operation. We went back to the Eisenhower Cottage. After a few hours, the gunman released the hostages unharmed and was arrested.

(The second of our two White House aides wasn't actually *released*. He said to the gunman, "Gee, it's hot in here, don't you think a six-pack of beer would be good?" When the gunman agreed with that proposal, our man walked out of the pro shop on an errand to get the beer, never to return.)

That night, our group had a pleasant dinner together. Nancy and I went to bed a little earlier than usual because we were tired after the early morning interruption the night before. At about 2:30 A.M., however, our phone rang again. Again it was Bud McFarlane: He said a suicide bomber had just driven a truckload of dynamite past our sentries and smashed into the marine barracks at the Beirut Airport. According to the first reports, at least one hundred marines had been killed.

There was to be no more sleep for us that night. I got on the phone with the Pentagon to make sure that everything possible was being done to protect the remaining marines in Beirut, then met with George Shultz and Bud for several hours in the same living room where we'd spent much of the night before. As dawn approached, the news from Beirut became grimmer and grimmer. At 6:30 A.M., we went to the airport, boarded Air Force One, and flew to Washington for